As Lies Unravel

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As Lies Unravel

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Summary

As the chipping escalates, Castaspella and Shadow Weaver team up to find a way to stop Prime before Micah hurts others or himself…

However, the dark sorceress will come to discover more than she expected.
Castaspella turns out to be a careful intertwining of threads that form a whole piece, but in her case, both truth and deceit have been woven together in coldly calculated stitches that now unravel before Shadow Weaver…

Notes

Wooh, okay, this one took a lot of effort to finish tbh, hence why we're posting just now, but uh, I promise we had a good reason XD
It was already the longest draft, but actually finishing and editing it was *complex* <("^_^)

Anyways!! I really hope u like this one, and it comes again with some art by Es :D

Thank you all for coming all this way with us, and please enjoy ^_^
~ Xenakis

See the end of the work for more notes

If there was one thing that could make Castaspella lose her mind completely, it was knowing the people she cared about were in danger. Glimmer's abduction, and her helplessness in all of it, frustrated and worried her endlessly.

At the same time, her brother had seemingly returned from the dead!

He hadn't even died to begin with. He had been here all this time and she didn't do a thing: couldn't have done a thing.

Castaspella promised herself she wouldn't let this happen again; he was back, she wouldn't lose him again.

After years of isolation, he managed to stay himself, her older brother came back home. Happy, familiar, and fleeting, like it had always been. Still a warrior at heart, he refused to leave the battlegrounds and remain safe in Mystacor… He wouldn't have been the Micah she knew, otherwise.

She knew it was a question of time before he was attacked, maybe hurt… so she made sure to keep an eye on him, if not her own then one of a subordinate.

Eventually, it happened. The camp where he was staying in the Whispering Woods was attacked, so she dropped everything and rushed there…

Somehow only Shadow Weaver had escaped. The rest were now… chipped? Mind-prisoners of Horde Prime.

She could certainly track them down easily, although she'd have to wait until she was away from the remaining Rebellion members. As for the foreign chip… she'd likely need her guild, who were currently preoccupied with keeping the citizens of Mystacor safe.

Well, it wouldn't happen soon, it seemed, so she'd have to see what's possible with those around her.

The princesses worked well as their own group, and she had no true intention of joining. Shadow Weaver, however… The old woman was acting quite strange, even seemed to… try to empathize with Castaspella regarding Micah's chipping.

And she *wanted* to work together!?

Realistically, this proposal was the best she could get for the war at this moment. In fact, she could maybe take advantage of this…

Letting Shadow Weaver believe herself the smartest person in the Woods, Castaspella finally accepted the deal and followed her. She didn't know where they were going, but she didn't need to.

If this was a trap, Castaspella could easily get rid of her; they were alone in the Woods… and no one would doubt her if she said the old woman ran away…

Still, she questioned Shadow Weaver from time to time, always putting up an act of "angry fool". However, opposite to the time Castaspella went to interrogate her, the old woman didn't seem to mock her for being "sloppy" as much as before.

Why? It didn't matter.

The Head Sorceress elected to ignore that and simply kept following her…

Eventually, she stopped trying to display her frailty, nor did she make any more comments about physical strain.

Perhaps, as she stopped complaining about exhaustion, it had started hitting Shadow Weaver. That could explain why her mockery was nowhere near as constant as it was during their first encounter.

Was she being more lenient because she really cared about Micah as she claimed?

Or was the old woman just noticing the cracks in Castaspella's act?

Well, it was worth testing one last time, so the sorceress threw all the usual accusations her way once again, and paid attention to Shadow Weaver's response.

If the old woman had any suspicions, she didn't show them… However, she had asked Castaspella to stop her if she tried to get the magic for herself.

It was a deal: one which left it implicit that Shadow Weaver trusted Castaspella could handle her, *subdue her*. She *trusted* her power would be enough against her.

Could that be her way of letting her know she was aware of her real abilities?

No. There was no fear in her voice, she was only trying to lure Castaspella into some false sense of security.

So they went on walking for a while more. At some point, her cape was left behind somewhere on the forest floor, though the other woman didn't seem to take notice.

Deep in thought as she was, the sorceress didn't realize Shadow Weaver had stopped.

—Huh? Are we there yet?

—Silence— the old woman ordered, keeping her voice low, and pulled her into cover behind some bushes. —There's someone in these ruins.

—Chipped people?

—Perhaps…

Quietly, they observed for a while until they saw three thugs walk out, heavily armed.

—I'm telling you, I heard something.

—Well, I don't see anyone out here, *idiot*.

As two of them bickered, the third one focused on their surroundings.

Shadow Weaver gestured at Castaspella to stay silent and not move, but they both knew there was a chance that the third one would notice them.

—Maybe it was a bird…

—Or maybe hunger is making you delusional— the second one laughed. —What you looking at? — he then asked the third one, who squinted at the bushes where the women hid. —Is hunger frying your brain too?

But the thug didn't answer. Instead, they grabbed a dagger from their belt and threw it at the bush.

Reacting on instinct, Castaspella stood up and cast a shield.

—Told ya I wasn't insane!

Observing their threat, the three thugs slowly advanced; one took out a falchion, another a pair of daggers, and the last one a whip.

The sorceress looked down with fear at Shadow Weaver, who was still hiding. The old woman seemed just as scared and, with trembling hands, attempted to cast something… but failed.

She couldn't do anything now, right? But *of course* Shadow Weaver wouldn't tell her that!

She was faced with two possibilities: either she focused on protection and hoped they would get tired… Or she could drop the act, deal swiftly with the threat, and then handle Shadow Weaver's reaction.

—Don't come closer— she decided to say, raising a hand but still too in-character to be menacing. —Leave these ruins… while you can.

The thugs, just like Shadow Weaver, couldn't take her seriously.

She had to be bluffing.

They were *not* intimidated in the slightest, and only pressed on; a pair of daggers flew towards her, she raised a new shield, and they bounced off of it.

—And tell us… How long can you cast those pretty shields of yours?

Swinging his falchion, the thug lunged forward and slashed down with all his might, cracking the shield.

—I don't think they last long…— the one with the whip snickered, stretching it menacingly.

Well…

They weren't exactly wrong.

Shadow Weaver closed her eyes for a moment, her magic was failing. Her mind scrambled for a plan, for a way out, but her body froze.

—Please, I don't want to do this— Castaspella said with somewhat of a tremble in her voice.

They burst into laughter; had the situation not been so dire, Shadow Weaver might've joined them.

—Look at that! She doesn't want to do it! And what are you going to do, lady? Throw us a tea party?

The man in the middle moved closer as he howled, his grip of the dagger tightening.

He bent over. Amidst the roar of his laughter a sound of a crack slipped through, more of a gargle even. His free hand ran to his large mouth, right below his dilated pupils beading with evil glee. Then his breath shortened and his spine shook; once again, the absurdity of the situation took his composure. It tore right through him.

But, this time, there was no sound. No laughter.

His body stopped shaking, his breaths were no longer loud and uneven, and just before he fell, Shadow Weaver looked up to see his eyes frantically darting around.

Like searching for *something*.

Not understanding, she looked back at Castaspella. Her typically furrowed brow had evened out as her facial muscles relaxed, and any sign of emotion left on her face slipped away.

The remaining enemies were too preoccupied with the state of their friend to notice the abrupt change.

Within seconds, she had become *unrecognizable*.

The shield had disappeared, but Castaspella's hands were still up; she was casting, but even Shadow Weaver couldn't figure out what.

This time, one of the frozen thugs shook, the attack was much more visible. A similar sound, a fast choking, through which the thugs had somehow managed to let out a strained scream.

Shadow Weaver finally stood up, shocked as she heard them wail in pain; their weapons fell on the ground, soon followed by themselves… their bodies twisting as they kept screeching.

This was… Castaspella's doing? *What* was she doing!?

Their bodies remained on the floor; their eyes were red, burns seeped into their skin from the inside, and there was a horrible smell in the air now.

Shadow Weaver finally realized what had happened…

—You boiled their blood!?

—They were three, and the initial shock wouldn't last; if I had tried something else, one could have escaped— the sorceress replied, with a monotonous voice.

The old woman felt insane for a moment. Castaspella spoke as if no murder had just happened, as if the smell of burnt flesh wasn't floating in the air.

She'd seen what danger and fear could do to people, how someone can be pushed to extremes they didn't even know they were capable of. It wouldn't be strange for her, or anyone, to act on instinct like that…

But this clearly *wasn't* instinct. This was a coldly calculated action.

A well planned one too: they *had* to be dealt with simultaneously. Gruesome, yes, but she did save them both.

Even in shock, she recognised that it had been… rather smart from Castaspella. Above that, it was powerful, dangerous.

Strange…

The old woman found herself hesitant for a second. In fact, she couldn't help considering whether she was in danger being alone with Castaspella.

But she *had* just saved them both, when she could have simply saved herself.

She didn't know what to make of it just yet, and so she kept quiet, concealing her surprise.

In front of her, Castaspella walked forward, gently stepping over the hand of one of the fallen men. She carefully lifted the hem of her dress, and her foot just barely missed a pool of blood.

Just like any noblewoman, afraid to dirty herself.

Her face expressionless still.

As they walked deeper into the ruins, the darkness barely illuminated by a sigil Castaspella drew, the old woman kept thinking about what happened outside.

Panic and confusion bit away at her, so she inquired the only way she could.

—So, it seems when you try hard enough, you do know how to be precise— Shadow Weaver uttered, without looking back.

—You give me too much credit. That… might've been just luck. Normally, I really am so *sloppy*, you know?— Castaspella hummed, though her words were flat.

—Sure…

That wasn't a statement, it was mockery, and Shadow Weaver was slowly becoming enraged.

Sloppy. Incompetent. *Weak*.

Her very own words, thrown right back at her. She hadn't even come to terms with being fooled, yet she was already faced with the fact that she was *tricked into fooling herself*.

An awful feeling came over her, that sting of disappointment: of *failure*.

The old woman turned to keep walking, and didn't stop until they had reached the deepest parts, where ancient murals covered the walls.

Hopefully, those held the key to defeat Horde Prime.

To free the chipped.

To save Micah…

After a few hours inspecting the murals, debating, and figuring out possible meanings, they decided to take a break. With a simple spell, the Head Sorceress produced some food and shared it with the other woman, much to her surprise.

They ate in silence and, once done, they rested back on the wall, at a prudent distance from each other. A spell drawn on the ground produced light and heat between them.

Castaspella's nerdy passion when examining the murals had almost managed to make her forget about… what happened outside.

Shadow Weaver opened her mouth to speak, but closed it again, her resolve wavering.

—What is it?— the Head Sorceress suddenly asked, making her jump slightly.

She had her eyes closed.

How had she…

—I was thinking about… what you did earlier. To save us— she tentatively began. —An interesting spell— she hummed, concealing her hesitation. —I do not recall it being in the curriculum, and it's certainly nowhere to be found in the Guild's resources. Would you mind sharing with me where you got it from? How you got it?

She tried to keep herself calm. Keeping her voice steady and authoritative, as if she were a teacher questioning a sneaky student: replicating the dynamic they previously had, or which they *seemed* to have had.

—If you're asking it like that, you must already know— she said, without looking at her.

She was right, she knew. She knew *exactly* where the books with such spells were stored, exactly how cautious you had to be to reach them, and just how *hard* it was to break the magical encryption on them.

Time, skill, thorough knowledge of Mystacor and its secrets, all were needed to just come *close* to this type of magic.

Being Head Sorceress might have given her extra access, private documents. However, not everything came from political authority and, either way, with how she cast that spell, she must have mastered it long before that crown ever touched her head.

—I find it difficult to believe that the same woman who throws fits over party decorations, and fails the basics of truth spells, goes to dig around in Mystacor's forbidden libraries.

She paused but no reaction came from the other woman.

She felt less and less like the Head Sorceress she met before… and more like someone who could, maybe, understand Shadow Weaver.

She resonated with her use of magic and her determination to master it; they had a similarity.

Mutual understanding overall seemed to be a good thing, but to her, being understood just meant being *read*; she relied too much on concealing her true intentions to let herself be seen like that.

Though that wasn't too much of a risk, their similarity was one that quickly became meaningless once faced with all their differences, the sides they took and roles they fulfilled.

Not to mention that magic was not everything, not to Castaspella: she did not live by her magic… she was known for everything but it. Why, hadn't she been named a prodigy? A great talent?

If only she had waited a few more years…

If only she had seen Castaspella's potential back then.

Inevitably, Shadow Weaver began thinking about how different things would have been if she had gotten *her* to help with the Spell of Obtainment instead of Micah.

She wanted to see Castaspella the same way she saw the rest: all her wards and students, enough potential to succeed, and *innocence to be moulded*.

However, no matter how hard she tried, Castaspella would not fit the image, and she was once again forced to come to terms with her lack of control over the woman next to her.

As they emerged from the ruins, Shadow Weaver froze on her tracks almost imperceptibly.

She had forgotten about the corpses outside.

—We should make haste and return— the sorceress let out, walking past her.

—Yes, we should— she agreed, her voice betraying how out of sorts she was.

Sparing the bodies a brief glance, Castaspella decided to ask —Do you think someone will find them? If so, I can always get rid of them.

—I don't think so, but there's always a chance. And we *shouldn't* take risks— she replied, folding her arms to appear nonchalant. —If you're sure you can… get rid of them, then go ahead. Be my guest.

She made it sound like a challenge but also like something unnecessary.

Whether it was necessary or not, she didn't really care. In truth, Shadow Weaver *wanted* her to dispose of the bodies as offered out of sheer curiosity.

How would she do something like that!?

She had to be bluffing…

Except that, last time, she wasn't bluffing, and something told the old woman she was dead serious this time too.

Castaspella, albeit uninterested, seemed to notice Shadow Weaver's morbid curiosity.

She didn't care about that, not enough to call her out anyways, and it didn't really take a genius to realize she was right about not taking risks…

So she let out a sigh and, with outmost skill, evidencing the years of practice, Castaspella extended her hand, palm up, and summoned one of her spiders from her terrariums back in Mystacor.

Big as her hand, the spider appeared… quite domestic. Shadow Weaver observed with awe how the little creature sat on her hand, obediently waiting for orders.

However, Castaspella didn't give any. Or at least, none verbal. She only let it fall on top of the first body, and the spider began working.

She repeated this process with the second and third body, before finally turning to leave.

—All done.

—Wha- Wait. How long will it take them to… do whatever they will do?— the old woman asked, disbelieving.

—Half an hour… give or take— Castaspella replied, eyes closed. —Trust me. There will be no trace left— she insisted. —And they know how to get back home on their own, so I don’t need to wait for them either.

Shadow Weaver was quite thankful for the mask covering her dumbfounded expression.

She was no stranger to using nature with her magic, but she never wandered past plants. Animals were conscious, unlike her flowers, and much more difficult to control, though, if done correctly, they could be used for so much more.

How had she never thought about something like this!?

Spiders trained to… hide evidence!?

It was baffling, at the very least, and impossible to believe to some point. Only when Shadow Weaver remembered all her preconceptions of Castaspella were wrong, did it become less unbelievable and more impressive.

She felt certain envy, even.

Realizing she was still staring at the spiders, hence, dallying behind, she forced herself to leave those thoughts aside and follow after the Head Sorceress.

They had to return to the hideout with the information they gathered.

The first half of the way, they walked in absolute silence. It didn’t seem to bother Castaspella in the slightest, opposite to how she behaved before, constantly talking.

It was making Shadow Weaver herself want to fill the silence…

However, maybe because she noticed her discomfort or something, the sorceress stopped and turned to look at her.

—What is it?

—Once this is over, you will come with me to Mystacor— the Head Sorceress sentenced.

She would… what!?

Where did that even come from!?

There were too many possibilities stemming from that statement, but Shadow Weaver stuck to her favourite one.

—Buying me off?

She did just get caught messing with very outlawed magic.

—You can go around and tell your incriminating stories, I do not fear it.

—Don’t you?

—Go back and tell those children that we went into the dark forest, overgrown with shadowy plants, that lifeless bodies were left behind, that blood was spilled, and don’t forget to mention that *you* took no part in any of it.

She flashed one of those innocent smiles and the biggest piece of the puzzle fell into place. A question she wasn't even fully aware she had.

All the ridiculous behaviour and that overbearing personality, it was what Shadow Weaver struggled to connect to her newfound knowledge of the woman. Why cover greatness with mediocrity?

Now she knew.

Castaspella was right. No one would believe what had happened, if not out of respect for her "goodness", then out of disbelief for her abilities. She wouldn’t even need to tell them, her reputation would do all the work for her as they all draw shortsighted conclusions.

Who would look twice at an idiot? She wouldn’t…

Snapping back to the situation at hand, there was a more relevant question: why take her to Mystacor?

Not that long ago, Shadow Weaver dreamed of a place in Mystacor, so sure she would thrive. Now, she understood that standing within Castaspella’s view was more constraining than any prison she’s been in.

It made her uneasy.

—Then, what do you propose?

—I offer you a chance, somewhere to go after this all ends— Castaspella began. —I trust we will succeed against Prime, and when that happens, your current… pass, so to speak, will expire. You’ll likely have nowhere to go, many will want you imprisoned, even. What I offer you is a place in Mystacor, a purpose— she explained.

The old woman had no idea what to say now, feeling speechless for a moment too long.

—Why?— she finally asked, since nothing good came to mind.

—Because it benefits me, why else?— she replied, still smiling. —You have so many skills and talents that could be used to improve the kingdom.

—So you intend to *fix me*, turn me into a loyal servant of Mystacor?— she insisted.

The idea humored her.

—Fix?— she repeated, letting out a small chuckle. —No, no. I only want to *manage you*. You see, your failures don't lie in your motives, they lie in your *methods*. You have such talents, and yet you don't know *when and where* to use them. The worst part? You try to compensate it with more power, more and more from others, but all you end up doing is wasting what they give you, just like you wasted your own— she explained. —With me commanding you, there's so much we can achieve; I believe I can make good use of your abilities. And if not, well, I could always use a scapegoat…— she concluded, mockingly.

This was…

Throughout her life she had switched sides, causes, wards, and pupils. The fight for good, for evil, it was all the same. But, now… this was a change she had never ever thought of.

The magic running through her veins... in foreign hands.

A fall. A *demotion*.

She was mocking her, right? Was this how it felt? How *they* felt?

She hadn't yet accepted any of this, however the uncharacteristic lack of a smug retort showed she could not refuse this either. The discomfort slowly settled within her.

—I see— Shadow Weaver finally let out.

Was this a reason to keep on living? Not enticing at all.

Finding a reason to die seemed easier than coping with that future.

They spent the rest of the trip in complete silence. The Head Sorceress simply led the way, stopping but a moment to recover her cape when they came across it on the Woods. But, of course, the wear and tear wouldn't do, so she discarded it again and produced a new one.

How easily she teleported it from her room was actually admirable.

Only once they stood outside the hideout, Castaspella spoke again.

—I quite value my life as it is, the people in it, especially. I won't ever let you so much as *risk* ruining it.

So she was more threatened than she had let on… but even so, Shadow Weaver wouldn't dare to take this risk.

There was a certain understanding between them now. Just enough for their dynamic to have changed, even when Castaspella returned to her "Aunt Casta" persona.

It was sudden. Too sudden. But the old woman made sure to show no signs of surprise.

But the anger… How could that sorceress fool her!?

Enraged, the old woman closed her fists tightly, and before she realized it, she had pulled Castaspella to the side and pinned her against a tree.

—You value your life, huh? And yet you play the most dangerous game like it's some righteous proceeding! So what!? Are you better than me because you commit crimes in the name of *good*!?— Shadow Weaver began, spiteful. —You're no better than me- I refuse to accept that!

—My, my… where is this coming from?— the Head Sorceress asked, raising a brow. —Did I strike a nerve or are you just letting your insecurity control you?— she taunted. —This lack of restraint… no wonder you need someone leading you— she then sentenced, serious. —I'm sure you're aware this is only counterproductive for us both…

—Hypocrite, you really are just like me. It's not just magic, all those mind games you accused me of…— the woman growled, gripping the sorceress tighter as her anger grew. —Where else were you pulling people's strings? Was the- was the deal with the truth spell failing another lie!?

—Yes— Castaspella admitted.

—So you decided to reveal your true power because we were in jeopardy? Is that it?

—Yes.

—Why not abandon me instead?— Shadow Weaver insisted, anger subduing in favour for confusion. —Why didn't you just save yourself?

—I'm not cruel; violent, maybe, that's why you call it crimes. I suppose they are, but you're *wrong*. I don't consider them righteous actions. Just what I must do to protect those around me— the Head Sorceress explained, remaining calm as if she wasn't pressed against a tree and being yelled at just a moment ago.

—Fine. So it was all an act; you being sloppy and such— the old woman seethed.

—And yet you asked for my help…

—To save Micah! He's your brother, and you had knowledge even if not- Even if I *thought* you didn't have talent— she explained.

—If you had known of my true skill, would it have made a difference?

—I- Yes— Shadow Weaver admitted. —But you choose to be… to… Your façade of idiocy smears any skill you carry. You command no respect— she pointed out. And for the first time Shadow Weaver spoke with no anger or curiosity, her words came from defeat. —Why?

—You should know the answer already— Castaspella defied her, staring into the white sockets of her mask, no more that a breath away from her face.

Soft blue fabric clashed against rough red robes. The golden halo's light shone on the old mask, revealing all of its scratches.

Shadow Weaver could say all she wanted, anyone could. Now it was clear how little it all mattered, even as the younger woman looked up, her back pressed into a rough surface, it was still clear who was the winner here.

Who had *always* been the winner.

Shadow Weaver barely held back a gasp. Taken aback, her eyes opened wide and she pulled back. The sorceress could see the exact moment when it all clicked in her head, but despite the smugness she felt, her face remained expressionless.

Dread spread through the old woman, like electricity through her body, and she took a step back.

She had been so wrong all this time. Thinking herself to have the winning card, only to be bested by someone like *her*…

Shadow Weaver let out a chuckle of disbelief.

—I see… I get it. You're- If it had been you back then… The Spell of Obtainment would have been but a breeze to you.

—But it would have *not* been me. Here you are not the teacher, and I am not your student— Castaspella stated —Now: do we have an agreement?— she asked, head held high and a hand extended towards Shadow Weaver.

—I… think we do.

They finally walked into the hideout with synchronized steps, the Head Sorceress looking down, seemingly sorrowful, while Shadow Weaver's sight remained up, *proud*.

She, too, now needed to keep appearances, not showing weakness… or fear.

—So, wait, hold on. Where have you two been this whole time again?— Bow asked, voicing everyone's confusion.

—While you were traipsing around in space, *some of us* have been working to stop the Heart of Etheria from falling into Prime's hands— she replied, condescendingly enough. Having overheard a bit of what they were talking inside, she went on —And we discovered the same thing you did. Rumors of a Failsafe that will break the restraints the First Ones built and set the stolen magic *free*.

—Are you kidding!? After everything that happened last time, you're still going after the Heart of Etheria!?— Queen Glimmer exclaimed, shocked. —And you're helping her!?— she then asked her aunt, sounding betrayed.

Expected, of course.

Now, what would she say to justify herself?

Shadow Weaver couldn't wait.

Approaching her and crouching a bit, Castaspella explained —We're trying to free the magic for *all* of Etheria, so we can be strong enough to fight Prime. I'm doing this for your father, and for you. Shadow Weaver is the *lesser* of two evils.

"Be strong enough", "for your father and for you", and "the lesser of two evils"…

The dark sorceress recognized something she would say, the essence of Castaspella's true motivations, and then what she knew *others* wanted to hear, like Catra, who immediately remarked that at least she admitted Shadow Weaver's evilness.

Words carefully chosen, indeed.

It still surprised the old woman. How easily she fell into this façade, how everyone was so easily fooled… how she had been fooled too.

However, this time, there was… someone who wasn't… falling for it.

At least not completely.

Once Adora got Shadow Weaver and Catra to stop arguing, Castaspella wanted to be the one to tell them what they discovered, and her dramatic storytelling was familiar enough to ease Glimmer for a moment.

Then, as they decided to infiltrate Mystacor, everyone had quickly scattered, each getting ready for the trip to Mystacor while Adora went to convince Catra to help them.

Since Glimmer found nothing to do, she simply sat down on some old crate. The initial surprise of her aunt teaming up with Shadow weaver was already wearing off.

Her aunt sat by her, tilting her head and smiling.

The young Queen recalled that Castaspella had once done so, on a soft couch in a well-furnished room with marbled walls, and now she was doing so in a dark hideout amidst dusty boxes. Her rough and newly calloused hands rested atop well ironed robes, which, if you looked closely enough, showed small lines of where tears had previously been.

Glimmer noticed.

But those were just details. The colour of the walls, the light in the room, they did not matter, it did not dim her smile… So why should this?

When they went on to fight against her father, Castaspella was the last to fall, but also the one to take the most damage from her brother. And as they left the chamber where the Crystal of Arxia was, with her seemingly on the brink of unconsciousness, Glimmer noticed her aunt was so clearly full of magical energy still.

That small contrast just blended in with the rest.

All the rumours, signs, militant action, all went out of focus and settled into the background. It's not that there's something Glimmer cannot *see,* not that theres something she does not *want to see*.

Her eyes skimmed over it all, she nodded in acknowledgement and then her head turned away from the direction that never interested her in the first place.

Aunt Casta likes to knit, she knows how to cook really well and, at night, they sit on the windowsill and she tells interesting stories, ones you could never find in any library.

It felt warm, not righteous or good, so Castaspella may as well be bad.

Labels can be torn away. Skin can become charred.

Its not what matters.

Glimmer will only ever look for the heat of a hand around her shoulder.

End Notes

Now yes, that was all XD
This series is now concluded :D

Thank you for reading, thanks for the comments and appreciation, and I hope we get to work with Es again :)
This was a fun experience, a bit sad the reason why the event was held, but at least it prompted the swift writing and posting of this series (/^\)

Thank you She-Ra for everything…
~ Xenakis

😎
~ es272

And the promised art :D



Please drop by the Archive and comment to let the creator know if you enjoyed their work!